Different colour combinations

Orange + red

How it feels

Hot, lively, bold. Red adds strength and orange warms; together they are like glowing embers.

When it suits

When you want **energy and courage**.

Specific shades



bright orange + red
loud



terracotta + wine
deep and warm



apricot + scarlet
soft



pumpkin + crimson
autumnal



peach + coral
gentle and playful

In practice

An orange scarf and **red lipstick**. Terracotta and wine in a living room.

Watch out

Large areas of both can feel **loud** and tiring.

Orange + yellow

How it feels

Sunny, light, joyful. Yellow brightens orange; like the sun over a field.

When it suits

When you want a **festive, sunny** mood or to support **creativity**.

Specific shades



orange + lemon
sunny



pumpkin + mustard
autumnal



apricot + butter
soft



amber + golden
festive



terracotta + ochre
earthy

In practice

A yellow and an orange cushion. A kitchen in warm tones.

Watch out

Rich orange + rich yellow can recall **fast food** or **warning graphics**.

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Orange + green

How it feels

Playful and natural. A garden or an autumn wood; green calms orange.

When it suits

When you want to join **warmth** with a **natural feel**.

Specific shades


pumpkin + olive
naturally


terracotta + sage
gentle and earthy


orange + dark green
rich


apricot + mint
fresh


rust + moss
woodland

In practice

Oranges and leaves. A green coat and an orange scarf.

Watch out

A sharp green + a sharp orange can feel **very loud**, even childish.

Orange + blue

How it feels

Spark and calm at once. Blue is the counterpart of orange on the colour wheel. The strongest contrast of warm and cool.

When it suits

When you want orange to **stand out**.

Specific shades


orange + cobalt
striking


terracotta + denim
earthy and calm


apricot + light blue
gentle


pumpkin + petrol
deep


peach + grey-blue
quiet

In practice

An orange accessory in a blue room. Blue jeans and an orange jumper.

Watch out

Mixed together they **turn brown**. Side by side both can strengthen each other, give one the main role.

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Orange + indigo

How it feels

Dramatic and evening-like. Orange next to a deep blue-violet feels like the setting sun in the evening sky.

When it suits

When you want **warmth in the dark** and dramatic beauty.

Specific shades


orange + indigo
dramatic


amber + midnight blue
evening-like


terracotta + navy
deep


apricot + ink
gentle on dark


rust + plum blue
festive

In practice

An indigo wall with an orange lamp. Evening lighting.

Watch out

Many dark areas and a rich orange can feel **heavy**; give indigo more room.

Orange + violet

How it feels

Playful and mysterious. A rich, exotic pair.

When it suits

When you want a feeling of **exoticism** and luxury.

Specific shades


orange + purple
boldly


peach + lavender
tenderly


terracotta + plum
deeply


mandarin + amethyst
playfully


apricot + lilac
gently

In practice

A violet scarf and an orange bag. A violet wall and orange accessories.

Watch out

Rich orange + rich violet is **very loud**; tone one down.

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Orange + pink

How it feels

Tender and warm. Pink is red diluted with white; with orange it gives peach, coral and apricot.

When it suits

When you want **tenderness and warmth**.

Specific shades


peach + powder
tenderly


coral + pale pink
playfully


orange + fuchsia
boldly


terracotta + dusty pink
earthy and gentle


salmon + apricot
tenderly

In practice

Coral and peach in a bedroom. A pink jumper and an orange scarf.

Watch out

Two sweet colours can be **too sweet**; add cream or wood.

Orange + grey

How it feels

Calm and modern. Grey calms orange and lets it stand out.

When it suits

When you want a **modern, restrained** look.

Specific shades


orange + anthracite
modern


terracotta + light grey
calm


apricot + dove
gentle


pumpkin + slate
elegant


peach + silver-grey
quiet

In practice

A grey sofa and an orange cushion. A grey coat and an orange hat.

Watch out

Grey + rich orange can recall **sports or work gear**.

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Orange + brown

How it feels

Earthy and homely. Brown grounds and warms orange.

When it suits

When you want **autumn warmth** and natural materials.

Specific shades


orange + chocolate
richly


apricot + caramel
softly


terracotta + dark wood
earthy


pumpkin + chestnut
autumnal


peach + beige
gently

In practice

A wooden table and orange ceramics. A leather jacket and an orange scarf.

Watch out

Two earthy colours can be **heavy**; add a light cream.

Orange + white

How it feels

Clean and fresh. White lifts orange up.

When it suits

When you want **lightness** and space.

Specific shades


orange + pure white
fresh


terracotta + cream
soft


apricot + milky
quiet


pumpkin + ivory
autumnal


rust + linen
natural

In practice

A white kitchen with orange ceramics. A white shirt and an orange scarf.

Watch out

Pure white + bright orange can be **sharp**; cream is gentler.

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Orange + black

How it feels

Strong and graphic. Black sets orange off; warmth becomes a striking contrast.

When it suits

When you want a **striking** or **festive** impression.

Specific shades


orange + black
striking


terracotta + charcoal
elegant


apricot + graphite
gentle


pumpkin + anthracite
autumnal


saffron + black
festive

In practice

A black dress and an orange handbag. Black furniture with a terracotta detail.

Watch out

If you do not want an impression of **Halloween** or sports kit, try only a little of it.

Orange + gold

How it feels

Sunset. Orange warms gold and gold softens orange. Together they feel warming and playful.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and light**.

Specific shades


orange + gold
radiantly


terracotta + antique gold
warmly


apricot + champagne
playfully


pumpkin + rich gold
richly


rust + matt gold
earthy

In practice

An orange jumper and a gold chain. An orange cushion and a gold lamp.

Watch out

Too many warm colours side by side tire. Try **adding green**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** orange, add **white**, **cream**, **peach** or **grey**.
- When you want to **ground** it, add **brown**, **terracotta**, **olive** or **natural materials**.
- When you want to **make it stand out**, add **blue**, **turquoise**, **indigo** or **black**.
- When you want to **cool it**, **blue**, **green** or **grey** will help.

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